

Competitor Scan -- Why Existing Tools Don't Answer the Research Question

Marketing Agent POC

What this is

A brief scan of existing AI marketing tools, done before the build, to clarify why this project exists and what gap it occupies. The research question is about agent architecture -- whether specialised agents produce better output than a single generalist. Existing tools answer a different question.

Tools Scanned

Jasper AI

What it does: LLM-powered copywriting tool. Single model, many templates. Output: Ad copy, blog posts, email sequences. Architecture: Single-agent. One LLM call per template fill. Why it doesn't answer the research question: Jasper is a well-engineered monolith -- it's what the marketing agent monolith prototype is. The research question is whether decomposing that into specialists with clean handoffs produces better output. Jasper is the baseline, not the answer.

Copy.ai

What it does: Generates marketing copy from a brief. Workflow builder in paid tier. Output: Ad variants, product descriptions, social posts. Architecture: Primarily single-agent. The workflow builder is sequential prompts, not specialist agents with distinct context scopes. Why it doesn't answer the research question: The workflow builder is closer to the multi-agent concept, but the stages share the same model with different prompts rather than agents with genuinely different context inputs. The audience persona is not derived from an independent analysis -- it's inferred inline by the copy generator.

ChatGPT (with browsing or plugins)

What it does: General-purpose LLM. Can write ad copy with a good prompt. Architecture: Single model, single context window. Why it doesn't answer the research question: This is the purest version of the monolith. The research question exists because ChatGPT with a marketing prompt produces "general public" as the audience and generic copy. The project tests whether a structured multi-agent pipeline fixes that.

Canva Magic Write / Adobe Express AI

What it does: Integrated copy generation inside design tools. Architecture: Single model, design-context prompt. Why it doesn't answer the research question: These tools optimise for design integration, not copy quality or audience specificity. The audience is assumed, not derived.

The Gap

None of these tools: 1. Derive a target audience from product image signals and use it as a hard constraint for copy generation 2. Run compliance checking as a separate deterministic stage (not a prompted suggestion) 3. Make the agent collaboration visible to the user in the output 4. Allow post-generation refinement that re-runs only the affected pipeline stages

The gap is not "there is no AI copywriting tool." The gap is: no existing tool treats campaign generation as a multi-agent collaboration problem with visible specialisation and selective re-runs. That is what this project tests.

What This Means for the Build

The monolith prototype (one Ollama call with a long marketing prompt) is intentionally the same as what Jasper and Copy.ai do at their core. Running it first and comparing its output to the multi-agent pipeline gives the research question a concrete, observable answer rather than a theoretical one.